

Chapter 68 Part 5

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The woman was wearing a black trench coat with a white shirt and black high-waisted long pants underneath. Her hair was casually tied up, and she was still wearing sunglasses. With one hand she held the little child, and with the other she held a large black umbrella.

The little child was also dressed all in black, obediently following the woman as they walked into the cemetery, then continued forward until they stopped in front of a tombstone with fresh flowers placed before it.

The woman took off her sunglasses, revealing one lifeless eye.

She crouched down halfway, took out the flowers and placed them in front of the tombstone, then looked at the person in the photo. Tears formed into pearls and fell.

The little child immediately moved closer to her, reaching out to wipe her tears. "Mommy, don't cry."

"Mommy is fine." The woman said, "I just miss your daddy a little."

The little child pressed her lips together, probably not yet understanding what it all meant.

To her, she hadn't seen her daddy since she was born.

She also didn't know what it felt like to suddenly not have a daddy.

She just felt sorry for her mommy.

"Sheng Yu, bow to your daddy." The woman wiped away her tears and said gently, "Introduce yourself to daddy, and your summary too."

Sheng Yu looked at the photo on the tombstone and said in a low voice, "Mommy, why is this photo in black and white? It doesn't look as good as the ones we have at home."

Su Yao's tears fell again in a rush, but she still patiently explained to Sheng Yu, "This is daddy's posthumous photo¹, but this picture was taken when daddy graduated from university. It's his graduation photo."

It had just been edited to black and white tones.

Sheng Yu seemed to understand and oh-ed, then faced the tombstone directly. Her crisp voice rang out: "Hello daddy, I'm Sheng Yu. I'm five years old this year, and this is my first time coming to see you. I was so curious about what you looked like, but mommy said I can never see you again, because you're in another world. So you have to be well in that other world, okay? Don't get sick, and don't be sad. Most importantly, can you bless mommy and stop her from crying anymore?"

"Also." Sheng Yu paused, puffing out her cheeks. "When I go to the other world in the future, will I be able to see you?"

Su Yao crouched in front of the tombstone. The large black umbrella enveloped her and Sheng Yu's figures, as if isolating them in a small world of their own.

She looked at the photo on the tombstone and suddenly smiled bitterly. "Even though I've already cried until one eye went blind for you, why do I still cry when I see your photo?"

"Sheng Qinglin." Su Yao called this name tenderly and affectionately. "You have to be well over there, okay? I've been dreaming about you a lot lately. Are you missing me?"

Su Yao shook her head on her own. "But I won't go keep you company. I have to take care of Sheng Yu until she grows up."

"Do you still remember? We used to dream about it—if we had a daughter in the future, we'd name her Sheng Yu. Although this promise came many years late, I've still fulfilled it." Su Yao said, "This is the bloodline I risked my life to keep for you. I almost went to find you in the delivery room."

"But you seemed quite prescient—you froze sperm abroad. Look, your daughter looks so much like you."

Su Yao crouched there, chattering on: "But I always feel like I've forgotten something. Big Brother² says that recovering to my current state is already very remarkable—I can still remember you, and I can still raise Sheng Yu."

"But I always feel like I've forgotten some important person, some important thing. Sometimes I'll cry for no reason when I'm spacing out. If you can hear me, can you tell me what exactly I've forgotten?"

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Footnotes

¹ *Posthumous photo* - "遗照" (yízhào) refers to a photograph of a deceased person displayed at funerals or placed on graves. In Chinese tradition, these are typically formal photos converted to black and white or sepia tones to indicate the person has passed away.

² *Big Brother* - "大哥" (dàgē) is a respectful term used to address an older male, either an actual older brother, an older male cousin, or sometimes a senior male friend or mentor. Given the context, this likely refers to Su Yao's older brother or a close male relative/friend who has been helping take care of her.